

Wednesday, March 11, 2026 at 12:50:05 Central Daylight Time

Subject: [External] Re: HerpConsBio Submission - Kauphusman et al. Cottonmouth Habitat Selection
Date: Tuesday, March 10, 2026 at 5:46:00 PM Central Daylight Time
From: David Germano
To: Gienger, Christopher M.
Attachments: Spring cottonmouth.jpeg

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Dear Dr. Gienger:

Your manuscript number is HCB 2026-018. Your paper will be sent out for review soon.

David J. Germano, Ph.D., Section Editor
Herpetological Conservation and Biology
Department of Biology 61 SCI
California State University, Bakersfield
Bakersfield, California 93311-1022
(661) 589-7846

From: Gienger, Christopher M. <giengerc@apsu.edu>
Sent: Monday, March 9, 2026 13:35
To: David Germano <dgermano@csub.edu>
Subject: HerpConsBio Submission - Kauphusman et al. Cottonmouth Habitat Selection

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09 March 2026

Dr. David Germano
Section Editor, *Herpetological Conservation and Biology*

Dear Dr. Germano,

We submit the attached manuscript, "*Generalist habitat selection by cottonmouths in a hydrologically-dynamic wetland*" for your consideration to be published in *Herpetological Conservation and Biology* as a Research Article. The manuscript investigates how Cottonmouths may adopt a generalist ecological strategy in dynamic hydrologic environments. Our manuscript uses multivariate analysis and machine learning, specifically Random Forest Modeling, to investigate the habitat preferences of Cottonmouths and to test the hypotheses that hydrologic fluctuation leads opportunistic (generalist) habitat selection strategies.

We can assert that all co-authors of our paper have worked on the manuscript (equal contributions) and that no part of our manuscript has appeared in any other paper in any form printed or electronic previously. The manuscript is not under consideration in any other journal.

Thank you for your consideration of our manuscript.

Chris

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